

Important

Here are some guidelines you should follow for this homework. Note that grade penalties may apply if you do not follow these guidelines.

1. All submitted code must compile under **JDK 25**. This includes unused code, so don't submit extra files that don't compile. Any compile errors will result in a 0.
2. Do not include any package declarations in your classes.
3. Do not change any existing class headers, constructors, instance/global variables, or method signatures. For example, do not add `throws` to the method headers since they are not necessary.
4. Do not add additional public methods.
5. Do not use anything that would trivialize the assignment. (e.g. Don't import/use `java.util.ArrayList` for an `ArrayList` assignment. Ask if you are unsure.)
6. Always be very conscious of efficiency. Even if your method is to be $O(n)$, traversing the structure multiple times is considered inefficient unless that is absolutely required (and that case is extremely rare).
7. You are expected to implement all methods on the homework. Each unimplemented method will result in a deduction.
8. You must submit your source code, the `.java` files, not the compiled `.class` files.
9. Only the active submission will be graded. Make sure your active submission has **all** required files.
10. After you submit your files, redownload them and run them to make sure they are what you intended to submit. You are responsible if you submit the wrong files.

Collaboration Policy

Every student is expected to read, understand and abide by the [Georgia Tech Academic Honor Code](#).

When working on homework assignments, you **may not** directly copy code from any source (other than your own past submissions). You are welcome to collaborate with peers and consult external resources, but you **must** personally write all of the code you submit. **You must list, at the top of each file in your submission, every student with whom you collaborated and every resource you consulted while completing the assignment.**

You may not directly share any files containing assignment code with other students or post your code publicly online. If you wish to store your code online in a personal **private** repository, you can use [GitHub Enterprise](#) to do this for free.

For this homework only, you also may not post any JUnit tests publicly, including on Piazza.

Violators of the collaboration policy for this course will be turned into the Office of Student Integrity.

Style and Formatting

It is important that your code is not only functional, but written clearly and with good programming style. Your code will be checked against a style checker. The style checker is provided to you, and is located on Canvas. It can be found under Files, along with instructions on how to use it. A point is deducted for every style error that occurs. If there is a discrepancy between what you wrote in accordance with good style and the style checker, then address your concerns with a Head TA.

Javadocs

You should add Javadocs to any helper methods you create in a style similar to the existing Javadocs. Any Javadocs you write must be useful and describe the contract, parameters, and return value of the method. Random or useless Javadocs added only to appease Checkstyle will lose points.

Vulgar/Obscene Language

Any submission that contains profanity, vulgar, or obscene language will receive an automatic zero on the assignment. This policy applies not only to comments/Javadocs, but also things like variable names.

Exceptions

When throwing exceptions, you must include a message by passing in a String as a parameter. **The message must be useful and tell the user what went wrong.** “Error”, “BAD THING HAPPENED”, and “fail” are not good messages. The name of the exception itself is not a good message.

For example:

Bad: `throw new IndexOutOfBoundsException("Index is out of bounds.");`

Good: `throw new IllegalArgumentException("Cannot insert null data into data structure.");`

In addition, you may not use try-catch blocks to catch an exception unless you catching an exception you have explicitly thrown yourself with the `throw new ExceptionName('Exception Message');` syntax (replacing `ExceptionName` and `Exception Message` with the actual exception name and message respectively).

Generics

If available, use the generic type of the class; do **not** use the raw type of the class. For example, use `new LinkedList<Integer>()` instead of `new LinkedList()`. Using the raw type of the class will result in a penalty.

Forbidden Statements

You may not use these in your code code for this homework assignment.

- `package`
- `System.arraycopy()`
- `clone()`
- `assert()`
- `Arrays` class
- `Array` class
- `Thread` class
- `Collections` class
- `Collection.toArray()`
- Reflection APIs
- Inner or nested classes
- Lambda Expressions

- Method References (using the `::` operator to obtain a reference to a method)

If you're not sure on whether you can use something, and it's not mentioned here or anywhere else in the homework files, just ask.

Debug print statements are fine, but nothing should be printed when we run your code. We expect clean runs - printing to the console when we're grading may result in a penalty.

JUnits

We have provided a **very basic** set of tests for your code. These tests do not guarantee the correctness of your code (by any measure), nor do they guarantee you any grade. You are encouraged to write your own tests to help verify correctness. For this homework, you may not post your tests on publicly, including on Piazza. For all homeworks, do **NOT** post your tests on the public GitHub or any other public source.

If you need help on running JUnits, there is a guide, available on Canvas under Files, to help you run JUnits on the command line or in IntelliJ.

ArrayList

You are to code an `ArrayList`, which is a list data structure backed by an array where all of the data is contiguous and aligned with index 0 of the array.

The `ArrayList` must follow the requirements stated in the Javadocs of each method you must implement. A constructor stub is provided for you to fill out.

Capacity

The starting capacity of the `ArrayList` should be the constant `INITIAL_CAPACITY` defined in `ArrayList.java`. Reference the constant as-is. Do **not** simply copy the value of the constant. Do **not** change the constant. If, while adding an element, the `ArrayList` does not have enough space, you should regrow the backing array to **twice** its old capacity. Do **not** resize the backing array when removing elements.

Adding

You will implement three `add()` methods. One will add to the front, one will add to the back, and one will add to anywhere in the list given a specific index. When adding to the front or the middle of the list, subsequent elements must be shifted back one position to make room for the new data. See the Javadocs for more details.

Removing

You will also implement three `remove()` methods - from the front, the back, or anywhere in the list given a specific index. When removing from the front or from the middle of the list, the element should be removed and all subsequent elements should be shifted forward by one position. When removing from the back, the last element should be set to `null` in the array. **All unused positions in the backing array must be set to null.** See the Javadocs for more details.

Amortized Efficiency

The efficiency of methods and algorithms in this course is often analyzed using a “per operation” analysis. That is, what is the worst this algorithm can do on any one instance? However, there are times where this type of analysis is unrealistically pessimistic. For example, in this homework, the `addToBack()` method is $O(1)$ for the most part except in the case of resizing, which is $O(n)$. However, a resize operation is rare enough that it’d be misleading to say that the method is $O(n)$.

In cases like this, we use an **amortized analysis**. This type of analysis adds up the cost of a series of operations and then averages the cost. Here, the resize step is $O(n)$, but since we double the capacity whenever the array gets full, we will not need to resize for another n add operations. So, putting that together with the common, cheap $O(1)$ operations, we get $O(1)$ using this analysis. Whenever this type of analysis is used, we will prefix the Big-O with the word **amortized**.

Differences between Java API and This Assignment

Some of the methods in this assignment are called different things or don’t exist in Java’s `ArrayList` class. This won’t matter until you tackle coding questions on the first exam, but it’s something to be aware of. The list below shows all methods with a different name and their Java API equivalent if it exists. The format is assignment method name $\Rightarrow$ Java API name.

- `addAtIndex(int index, T data)` $\Rightarrow$ `add(int index, T data)`
- `addToFront(T data)` $\Rightarrow$ no explicit method

- `addToBack(T data) ⇒ add(T data)`
- `removeAtIndex(int index) ⇒ remove(int index)`
- `removeFromFront()` ⇒ no explicit method
- `removeFromBack()` ⇒ no explicit method

SinglyLinkedList

You are to code a `SinglyLinkedList` with a head reference, but no tail reference. A linked list is a collection of nodes, each having a data item and references to other nodes. In a `SinglyLinkedList`, each node has a reference to the next node.

Do **not** use a phantom node to represent the start or end of your list. A phantom or sentinel node is a node that does not store data held by the list and is used solely to indicate the start or end of a linked list. If your list contains n elements, then it should contain exactly n nodes.

The `SinglyLinkedList` must follow the requirements stated in the Javadocs of each method you must implement. Your linked list implementation will use the default constructor (the one with no parameters) which is automatically provided by Java. Do **not** write your own constructor.

Nodes

The linked list consists of nodes. A class `SinglyLinkedList` is provided to you. This class has getter and setter methods to access and mutate the structure of the nodes.

Adding

You will implement three `add()` methods. One will add to the front, one will add to the back, and one will add to anywhere in the list given a specific index. See the Javadocs for more details.

Removing

You will also implement three `remove()` methods - from the front, the back, or anywhere in the list given a specific index. Make sure that there is no longer any way to access the removed node so that the node will be garbage collected. See the Javadocs for more details.

Garbage Collection

Java will automatically mark objects for garbage collection based on whether there is any means of accessing the object. In other words, if we want to remove a node from the list, we must remove all references **to that node**. What the next reference of that node points to doesn't particularly matter. As long as no references can reach the node, the node will be garbage collected eventually.

Equality

There are two ways of defining objects as equal: reference equality and value equality.

Reference equality is used when using the `==` operator. If two objects are equal by reference equality, that means that they have the exact same memory locations. For example, say we have a `Person` object with a name and id field. If you're using reference equality, two `Person` objects won't be considered equal unless they have the exact same memory location (are the exact same object), even if they have the same name and id.

Value equality is used when using the `.equals()` method. Here, the definition of equality is custom made for the object. For example, in that `Person` example above, we may want two objects to be considered equal if they have the same name and id.

Keep in mind which makes more sense to use while you are coding. **You will want to use value equality in most cases in this course when comparing objects. Notable cases where you'd use reference equality include checking for null or comparing primitives (in this case, it's just the `==` operator being overloaded).**

Differences between Java API and This Assignment

Some of the methods in this assignment are called different things or don't exist in Java's `LinkedList` class. Additionally, Java's built in `LinkedList` is a Doubly-Linked List, so the efficiency of some operations will differ. This won't matter until you tackle coding questions on the first exam, but it's something to be aware of. The list below shows all methods with a different name and their Java API equivalent if it exists. The format is assignment method name Java API name.

- `addAtIndex(int index, T data)` $\Rightarrow$ `add(int index, T data)`
- `addToFront(T data)` $\Rightarrow$ `addFirst(T data)`
- `addToBack(T data)` $\Rightarrow$ `add(T data)` or `addLast(T data)`
- `removeAtIndex(int index)` $\Rightarrow$ `remove(int index)`
- `removeFromFront()` $\Rightarrow$ `poll()` or `pollFirst()`
- `removeFromBack()` $\Rightarrow$ `pollLast()`

Grading

Here is the grading breakdown for the assignment. There are various deductions not listed that are incurred when breaking the rules listed in this PDF and in other various circumstances.

ArrayList Methods:	
constructor	1pt
addAtIndex	14pts
removeAtIndex	10pts
SinglyLinkedList Methods:	
addAtIndex	12pts
addToFront	6pts
addToBack	6pts
removeAtIndex	14pts
removeFromFront	6pts
removeFromBack	6pts
Other:	
Checkstyle	10pts
Efficiency	15pts
Total:	100pts

Provided

The following file(s) have been provided to you. There are several, but we've noted the ones to edit.

1. `ArrayList.java`

This is the class in which you will implement the `ArrayList`. Feel free to add private helper methods but **do not add any new public methods, inner/nested classes, instance variables, or static variables.**

2. `SinglyLinkedList.java`

This is the class in which you will implement the `SinglyLinkedList`. Feel free to add private helper methods but **do not add any new public methods, inner/nested classes, instance variables, or static variables.**

3. `StudentTest.java`

This is the test class that contains a set of tests covering the basic operations on the `ArrayList` and `SinglyLinkedList` classes. It is not intended to be exhaustive and does not guarantee any type of grade. **Write your own tests to ensure you cover all edge cases.**

Deliverables

You must submit **all** of the following file(s). Make sure the filename(s) matches the filename(s) below, and that *only* the following file(s) are present. If there are multiple files, do not zip up the files before submitting; submit them all as separate files.

Once submitted, double check that it has uploaded properly on Gradescope. To do this, download

your uploaded file(s) to a new folder, copy over the support file(s), recompile, and run. It is your sole responsibility to re-test your submission and discover editing oddities, upload issues, etc.

1. `ArrayList.java`
2. `SinglyLinkedList.java`

Autograder

The autograder for this homework will give you some helpful information, but it will be limited. Every time you submit, you will receive info about any compiler errors, Checkstyle deductions, and general formatting issues. The **first three times per day** you submit, you will see your per-method score. You will not see the number of failed tests or any information about the tests themselves.

Note that while this score is generally representative, **it is not final**. We go over each submission manually, and it is possible for autograder points earned to be deducted in certain cases, including, but not limited to, attempting to brute-force test cases. Additionally, we will manually grade efficiency, so that score is not included in the autograder score. Finally, **we reserve the right to update our test cases** should any defects be discovered, which may result in slight changes to your autograder score.